Hack with the Flow: n8n Buildathon Qualifying Round

Welcome to the Qualifying Round! This is your test to turn repetitive friction into automated workflows that run entirely on their own.

Instructions & Submission Requirements

1. Check out your chosen track and dive into the problem statement.
2. Use the Template provided.
3. Work your magic using n8n to build a real-world, practical solution to the given problem statement.
4. Fill out the submission form with:
    - **Team Name**
    - **Team Members** *(Up to 3 members)*
    - **Workflow Screenshot** *(Full canvas view showing your node layout, One photo only)*
    - **Recording & Pitch Video** *(2–5 minute demo showing execution of the workflow + explanation of the workflow + specific track answers)*
    - **Link to Workflow (URL)**
5. Submission Deadline: **Saturday, October 31st @ 10:00 PM**
6. **Submission Form**

Qualifying Round Rules & Guidelines

1. All submitted workflows must be built and executed on the designated n8n instance: khylepanganiban.app.n8n.cloud. Submissions built on separate or local instances will not be accepted.
2. Workflows must actively use the required nodes specified for your chosen track (including n8n native nodes, Gmail, Google Sheets, Google Calendar, or AI integration nodes).
3. For Google Sheets Gmail, and Google Calendar data, feel free to build your own custom setup or terms, provided that the mandatory data input/output originates exclusively from the provided HTTP Request Nodes.
4. Max of 3 members per team. All members must submit under one registered Team Name.
5. Video recordings must be strictly between 2 and 5 minutes. It must show the workflow in action and explicitly address the track-specific questions.

6. All workflows must be original work created specifically for this buildathon round. Plagiarism or duplicate workflows will result in disqualification.
7. The Top 3 teams per track must be available to compete live on November 7 1PM - 6PM at [To be announced, within NCR].

What's Next? (The On-Site Buildathon)

The Top 3 teams per track will qualify to join us live on-site!

- **Date & Time:** November 7 (1:00 PM – 6:00 PM)
- **Venue:** To be announced (within NCR)
- **What to Bring:** Laptop + charger, reusable water bottle, and your wildest workflow ideas!
- Exciting prizes await the most innovative, creative, and impactful automated workflows per track!

Need Help or Have Questions?

If you have any questions or need assistance during the Qualifying Round, feel free to reach out to us!

- **Email:** hello.n8nphusergroup@gmail.com
- **n8n Philippines User Group Facebook Page**

Stop clicking, start orchestrating. Let's get hyped to automate everything! ⚡

Buildathon Tracks

Track	Focus Area
Track A – Smart Event Engagement	Streamline event logistics, coordinate registrations, or build seamless attendee check-in and communication pipelines.
Track B – AI-Driven Task & Inbox Organizer	Ditch the clutter by building automated sorting engines, smart task prioritizing systems, and deep inbox filters.
Track C – Intelligent Customer Concierge	Design automated lead nurturing flows, responsive customer support routing, or interactive follow-up engines.
Track D – Post-meeting Action Engine	Weaponize artificial intelligence to automatically capture meeting action items, summarize transcripts, or assign tasks.

Criteria of Judging (4):

Criteria	Description
Functionality (25%)	Workflow runs live and genuinely uses all five required tools
Technical Execution (25%)	Sensible node structure, correct data mapping, robustness beyond demo input
Creativity (25%)	Scenario sharply solves a real problem within the track
Presentation (25%)	Clarity of live demo and 1-page documentation

Track A – Smart Event Engagement

AI-Powered Developer Summit Registration & Dynamic Personalization

Managing large-scale technical conferences often leads to logistical bottlenecks, fragmented attendee data, manual scheduling errors, and generic, unengaging participant communication.

As a lead event engineer, your challenge is to design an end-to-end automated orchestration pipeline using n8n that completely automates developer registration for a high-impact developer summit.

When a developer registers, your system must dynamically parse and evaluate their tech stack preferences, experience level, and interests using AI.

Based on this intelligence, the workflow should automatically generate a fully personalized workshop schedule tailored to the participant, assign optimal calendar slots without scheduling overlaps, store organized attendee records, and generate a beautifully formatted, styled HTML confirmation email featuring their custom schedule alongside synced Google Calendar invites.

Required Nodes to Include

Your workflow must actively incorporate and execute the following nodes:

1. **HTTP Request Node:** Use the HTTP Request Node provided in the template (to generate incoming registration entries)
2. **AI Node:** LangChain / OpenAI / Openrouter (for parsing tech stacks, categorizing interests, and matching optimal workshop tracks)
3. **Google Sheets Node:** Google Sheets (for reading workshop catalog data and updating/logging attendee profiles)
4. **Google Calendar Node:** Google Calendar (for dynamically creating or attaching personalized schedule calendar invites)
5. **Gmail Node:** Gmail (for dispatching rich HTML confirmation emails)

Workflow Template

Before we begin building, you need to load this starter template into the n8n workspace. Follow these simple steps:

1. Click the workflow template JSON provided: **Link**
2. Select the entire wall of text from the very first open bracket `{` to the very last closing bracket `}` and copy it to your clipboard (`Ctrl+C` or `Cmd+C`).
3. Go to the n8n dashboard and create a brand-new, empty workflow.
4. Click anywhere on the clean grid background of your canvas and simply paste the code (`Ctrl+V` or `Cmd+V`).

Track-Specific Pitch & Recording Questions

During your 2–5 minute demo video, your team must address the following questions:

1. *How did you structure your n8n workflow to handle non-deterministic AI outputs while ensuring accurate, non-overlapping workshop assignments for each attendee?*
    a. Explain your prompt engineering strategy, structured output parsing, and error-handling steps when matching developer tech stacks to the event agenda.
2. *How does your system gracefully process duplicate registrations, invalid input data, or fully booked workshop slots in Google Sheets and Google Calendar?*
    a. Detail the fallback mechanisms or conditional routing you built to maintain data integrity under high-concurrency registration scenarios.
3. *How does this automated solution transform the conference operational workflow, and how easily could it scale to handle tens of thousands of attendees across multiple event tracks?*
    a. Describe the time and cost savings for event organizers and how your design can be adapted for broader real-world enterprise use cases.

Submission Form

Template Link

Track B – AI-Driven Task & Inbox Organizer

AI-Powered Content Creator Idea Box & Multi-Platform Calendar Pipeline

Content creators, media agencies, and marketing teams often struggle with scattered brain dumps, unorganized voice notes, and fragmented raw ideas across their digital notes apps.

Converting these spontaneous thoughts into a structured, executable content strategy usually requires hours of manual sorting, platform-matching, theme tagging, and calendar scheduling.

As a lead automation engineer, your challenge is to design an end-to-end automated orchestration pipeline using n8n that transforms raw creator notes into an organized, multi-platform content calendar.

When a creator inputs a raw, unformatted note or stream-of-consciousness idea, your system must dynamically analyze the content using AI.

The workflow should extract the core concept, determine the optimal publishing platform (e.g., YouTube, TikTok, LinkedIn, or Blog), assign appropriate theme tags, log the structured content into a master tracking sheet, schedule draft publishing deadlines on Google Calendar, and send an automated digest/alert email summarizing the newly cataloged content plan.

Required Nodes to Include

Your workflow must actively incorporate and execute the following nodes:

1. **HTTP Request Node:** Use the HTTP Request Node provided in the template (to generate/receive raw note entries)
2. **AI Node:** LangChain / OpenAI / Openrouter (for parsing raw text, extracting topics, selecting target platforms, and auto-tagging themes)
3. **Google Sheets Node:** Google Sheets (for logging structured content ideas, status tracking, platform tags, and content pipelines)

4. **Google Calendar Node:** Google Calendar (for automatically creating content creation deadlines and publishing reminders)
5. **Gmail Node:** Gmail (for dispatching rich HTML content digest notifications or alerts to the creator/team)

Workflow Template

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Track-Specific Pitch & Recording Questions

During your 2–5 minute demo video, your team must address the following questions:

1. How did you structure your n8n workflow to reliably parse messy, unstructured creator notes into consistent AI outputs across different platforms?
    - Explain your prompt engineering techniques, JSON/structured output enforcement, and fallback logic when the AI encounters vague or incomplete note submissions.
2. How does your system handle platform-specific scheduling rules, duplicate idea detection, or updating existing content entries in Google Sheets and Google Calendar?
    - Detail the conditional branching, data lookups, and routing logic you built to ensure content isn't duplicated and target release dates match platform production timelines.
3. How does this automated idea engine optimize the creator workflow, and how could it be expanded to auto-generate actual content scripts or assets for enterprise marketing teams?
    - Describe the time saved for solopreneurs or creative agencies and how your architecture can scale to integrate with social media posting APIs or AI asset generation tools.

Submission Form

Track C – Intelligent Customer Concierge

Rule-Based Guest Request Automation & Front-Desk Log Sync

Managing incoming guest requests, such as room upgrades, special accommodations, dietary preferences, or early check-in requests—often causes operational strain, delayed response times, and fragmented front-desk communication.

As a lead automation engineer in the hospitality sector, your challenge is to design an end-to-end automated orchestration pipeline using n8n that streamlines hotel guest request management using structured rules and template-driven logic.

When a guest sends a special request or booking modification form, your system must categorize the inquiry based on request types (e.g., early check-in, room type change, amenity request).

Based on room availability and hotel policy rules, the workflow should generate a professional confirmation or alternative option response using rich HTML templates, log the request details into the front-desk guest tracking sheet, and automatically schedule front-desk staff follow-ups or room block updates via Google Calendar.

Required Nodes to Include

Your workflow must actively incorporate and execute the following nodes:

1. **HTTP Request Node:** Use the HTTP Request Node provided in the template (to generate/receive incoming guest requests)
2. **Logic & Data Nodes:** Switch / Filter / Code / Set Nodes (for evaluating request category, checking availability conditions, and assembling pre-formatted email templates)
3. **Google Sheets Node:** Google Sheets (for reading room availability logs and updating/logging active guest requests)
4. **Google Calendar Node:** Google Calendar (for scheduling front-desk operational tasks, check-in time adjustments, or room block holds)

5. **Gmail Node**: Gmail (for dispatching rich HTML confirmation or alternative proposal emails directly to the guest)

Workflow Template

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3. Go to the n8n dashboard and create a brand-new, empty workflow.
4. Click anywhere on the clean grid background of your canvas and simply paste the code (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V).

Track-Specific Pitch & Recording Questions

During your 2–5 minute demo video, your team must address the following questions:

1. How did you structure your n8n conditional routing to process different guest request types while ensuring policy-compliant responses?
    - Explain your switch rules, template data injection, and decision-tree logic when processing room modifications or early check-in inquiries.
2. How does your system handle edge cases, such as conflicting room availability, fully booked early check-ins, or duplicate requests from the same guest?
    - Detail the conditional logic, lookup routines, and state-checking mechanisms you built to prevent front-desk scheduling errors and maintain data integrity in Google Sheets.
3. How does this automated guest service solution transform hotel front-desk operations, and how easily could it scale to manage hundreds of rooms across a hotel chain?
    - Describe the time saved for hospitality staff, the impact on guest satisfaction scores, and how your architecture can integrate with other property management systems (PMS).

Submission Form

Template Link

Track D – Post-meeting Action Engine

Rule-Based Healthcare Shift Handover & Checklist Dispatch Pipeline

During nursing shift changes in hospitals and medical clinics, transmitting critical patient information often relies on handwritten notes, verbal handoffs, or fragmented digital transcripts. This manual process introduces risks of missed medication times, forgotten doctor orders, and delayed patient care.

As a lead healthcare automation engineer, your challenge is to design an end-to-end automated orchestration pipeline using n8n that standardizes and automates nurse shift handovers using structured rules and logic.

When a nurse submits a shift handoff transcript or structured update form, your system must evaluate and parse key data fields (such as patient IDs, vitals, medication schedules, and doctor order tags).

The workflow should automatically extract critical care updates, map them against pre-defined urgency thresholds, record organized handover entries in a master Google Sheets log, schedule critical medication reminders on Google Calendar, and send an immediate structured HTML checklist email to incoming medical staff.

Required Nodes to Include

Your workflow must actively incorporate and execute the following nodes:

1. **HTTP Request Node:** Use the HTTP Request Node provided in the template (to generate/receive incoming shift transcript entries)
2. **Logic & Data Nodes:** Switch / Filter / Code / Set Nodes (for parsing transcript text, extracting medication times/orders, and mapping urgency rules)
3. **Google Sheets Node:** Google Sheets (for logging patient handover records, updating status trackers, and maintaining shift logs)
4. **Google Calendar Node:** Google Calendar (for scheduling critical medication windows, doctor round alerts, and care reminders)
5. **Gmail Node:** Gmail (for dispatching rich HTML shift-change checklists directly to incoming medical staff)

Workflow Template

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3. Go to the n8n dashboard and create a brand-new, empty workflow.
4. Click anywhere on the clean grid background of your canvas and simply paste the code (Ctrl+V or Cmd+V).

Track-Specific Pitch & Recording Questions

During your 2–5 minute demo video, your team must address the following questions:

1. How did you structure your n8n workflow logic to reliably extract patient IDs, medication times, and doctor orders without relying on AI?
    - Explain your string parsing techniques, regex/keyword matching rules, and data transformation logic for structuring raw nursing transcripts.
2. How does your system handle edge cases, such as ambiguous shift entries, missing medication times, or duplicate handover submissions for the same patient?
    - Detail the fallback validation checks, conditional branches, and state verification rules you built to prevent medical logging errors and protect patient data integrity in Google Sheets.
3. How does this automated handover pipeline improve clinical efficiency, and how easily could it scale across multiple hospital wards or electronic health record (EHR) systems?
    - Describe the time saved during nursing shift changes, the reduction in patient safety risks, and how your rule-based design can integrate with broader healthcare management software.

Submission Form

Template Link